Only the tools it needs

AI security · Upper secondary · Lesson 2



In this lesson you will

- Tell reading tools from acting tools.
- Give an agent the fewest tools, with an allow-list in code.
- Require a person's yes before any tool acts.

Remember

- Reading tools can leak; acting tools can be turned against you.
- Least privilege: the fewest tools, for the shortest time.
- An allow-list and a person's yes, checked in code.

Activity: Permission plan

1. Warm-up (3 min): List what one app on your phone can do.
2. Plan (7 min): Pick an agent; list its tools; mark reading or acting.
3. Attack (5 min): Test three tampered results against your plan.
4. Share (5 min): Compare blast radius with a partner.

Use a family phone only with its owner. The tampered results are made up: write them on paper.

Let’s discuss

1. Why is a reading tool safer than an acting tool?
2. Why must the yes be checked in code, and not by the model?
3. Which app on your phone has more power than it needs?

Check yourself

- Write the allow-list for one task, and mark the tool that needs a yes.